THE NEW ICEBERG Theory

Sixteen months ago, I stepped onto the university campus for the first time—everything around me was far beyond what the word unfamiliar could describe. But none of that really mattered. For a long time, even though problems came at me like heavy rain, I found myself obsessing over a single and ultimate question: “What do I actually want?”
Coursework, house chores, learning how to drive, student organizations—whether trivial or “important,” these things quickly crowded my life, leaving me little room to breathe and think about that “ultimate question”. Sometimes in the middle, I would convince myself I had already found the answer. After all, answers were everywhere. My parents told me grades and academic achievement were a student’s natural duty. My peers insisted that clubs and friendships defined youth. Online, countless voices confidently presented themselves as instructors in the art of success and happiness.
But who was right? Was anyone right at all?
Six months ago, I began my first internship as an operations engineer at a software company. It was painfully boring. Thousands of pages of training documents endlessly detailed the life of an outdated and useless piece of software. My coworkers told me it would take at least three months just to finish the training. I felt no curiosity toward a job so lacking in generosity or adventure.
Five months ago, I started my second internship. This time, I was asked to independently build a company-wide materials distribution management website—in two weeks, with nothing provided: no blueprint, no design, no resources, almost nothing at all. It sounded impossible.
But within half a day, a coworker taught me how to use AI-assisted tools to build websites. I began immediately. I had never studied UI design, front-end or back-end development, databases, deployment, or domain management. Yet within fifteen hours, the entire site was fully functional. My coworkers were all very satisfied and put it into use immediately.
I felt the true happiness at that moment, the answer to my ultimate question finally began to emerge. I realized that a new era of this world had already begun.

Heroism

Heroism became one of my central themes. In this noisy era, countless imposed rules pressure us to conform. They imprison our thinking, convincing us that everything must still proceed step by step—that students can only be students, individuals can only be individuals, and we can only do what external systems assign us. But that is no longer true.
This is an age of heroism. Every individual has already been granted extraordinary power. We possess the most valuable resource in the world in near-infinite abundance: knowledge. One person can function as an entire army. One pair of hands can grasp the world itself. Is there anything more terrifying than this? Yes.
A person being given all of this power—without realizing it.

Flexibility

Finally, this is why Flexibility is a core theme of my work. I hope never to be confined within a single way of thinking. I want to retain the courage to question myself, to question my surroundings, and to question the world—constantly and honestly. Only by remaining flexible can one move with the world rather than be left behind by it.

Happiness

This is why the first theme is the theory of happiness. The ultimate question for me is ultimately a quest for own definition of happiness. I believe the sole purpose of life is happiness. Ironically, humans are naturally inclined to believe happiness comes from changes in external conditions. We search relentlessly outward—for happiness itself, and for definitions of happiness. Yet happiness has never truly existed outside of us. It is something uniquely internal. By changing one’s understanding of happiness, a person can move from sorrow to joy even if external circumstances remain unchanged. A disabled person, may either grieve the injustice of the world or feel gratitude for the value of life itself. Of course, this shift is not easy—which is why I constantly return to the question: What do I actually want?

Learning and education form the foundation of both society and the individual growth. Since the beginning of human species, learning has followed a single dominant logic: study hard, spend enough time, move steadily step by step—like climbing one mountain after another.
But with the arrival of the AI era, the world no longer develops in orderly progression. Countless new inventions and ideas emerge daily. Entire professions become replaceable. Knowledge becomes increasingly accessible. Skills that once seemed as insurmountable as towering peaks now resemble icebergs—where understanding the surface is often enough to accomplish eighty or ninety percent of the task.
So what does this mean?
Rather than slowly ascending one mountain at a time, we should be jumping across the peaks of icebergs—reaching the top first, then descending only when deeper understanding is necessary. Yet society’s approach to learning remains stubbornly unchanged. This is tragic. How many people waste their most valuable years in meaningless “effort,” swallowed by the quicksand of a rapidly shifting world, unable to see either the world clearly—or themselves?